

Day 69 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Polity (3): Chief Justice of India & Judiciary

READING MATERIAL

Covers the current Chief Justice of India, the CJI succession process and upcoming appointments, and the Supreme Court's current composition.

Q: Who is the current Chief Justice of India, and when was he sworn in?

A: Justice Surya Kant — the 53rd CJI, sworn in on 24 November 2025.

Q: Who was the previous CJI, and why did he demit office?

A: Justice B.R. Gavai — demitted office on 23 November 2025, upon attaining the mandatory retirement age of 65.

Q: How is the Chief Justice of India typically appointed, in practice?

A: Through the convention of SENIORITY — the outgoing CJI recommends their successor, who is generally the next senior-most judge of the Supreme Court.

Q: Who is set to become CJI after Justice Surya Kant, and for what period?

A: Justice Vikram Nath — from 7 February 2027 to 23 September 2027.

Q: What is the Supreme Court's current sanctioned judge strength, and how does this connect to a Bill covered elsewhere?

A: 37 judges (excluding the CJI) — confirming that the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026 (already covered in a4-current-affairs-1) had been implemented by mid-2026, increasing strength from the earlier 33.

Q: Who are the Supreme Court's current female judges?

A: Justice B.V. Nagarathna and Justice V. Mohana.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Who is the current Chief Justice of India (sworn in 24 November 2025)?

- A. Justice B.R. Gavai
- B. Justice Surya Kant ✓**
- C. Justice Vikram Nath
- D. Justice D.Y. Chandrachud

Explanation: Justice Surya Kant. [medium, web-research]

2. Justice Surya Kant is the ____ Chief Justice of India.

- A. 50th
- B. 51st
- C. 52nd
- D. 53rd ✓**

Explanation: 53rd. [hard, web-research]

3. Who preceded Justice Surya Kant as Chief Justice of India?

- A. Justice D.Y. Chandrachud
- B. Justice B.R. Gavai ✓**
- C. Justice Vikram Nath
- D. Justice Narasimha

Explanation: Justice B.R. Gavai. [medium, web-research]

4. The Chief Justice of India is appointed, by convention, primarily based on:

- A. Seniority among Supreme Court judges ✓**
- B. A public election
- C. Parliamentary vote
- D. State government nominations

Explanation: Seniority. [medium, web-research]

5. As of mid-2026, the Supreme Court's sanctioned strength (excluding the CJI) is:

- A. 30
- B. 33
- C. 35
- D. 37 ✓**

Explanation: 37. [hard, web-research]

6. Which of the following is a current female judge of the Supreme Court of India?

- A. Justice B.V. Nagarathna ✓**
- B. Justice Surya Kant
- C. Justice Vikram Nath
- D. Justice B.R. Gavai

Explanation: Justice B.V. Nagarathna. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Ratio and Proportion

READING MATERIAL

Ratio & Proportion is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills, and real exam evidence shows it's tested through several distinct shapes, not just 'simplify this ratio'. Learn each shape as its own method.

Q: Real exam (2025): A man spends Rs.500 buying 12 tables and chairs. One table costs Rs.50, one chair costs Rs.40. Find the ratio of chairs to tables purchased.

A: Let tables= t , chairs= c . $t+c=12$ and $50t+40c=500$ (i.e. $5t+4c=50$). Substitute $t=12-c$: $5(12-c)+4c=50 \rightarrow 60-5c+4c=50 \rightarrow c=10$, so $t=2$. Ratio chairs:tables = $10:2 = 5:1$.

Q: Method — combining two ratios that share a common term: If $a:b=3:5$ and $b:c=7:8$, find $a:c$.

A: To chain two ratios, scale each so the SHARED term (b) matches in both. Here b is 5 in the first ratio and 7 in the second — $\text{LCM}(5,7)=35$. Scale $a:b=3:5$ by $\times 7 \rightarrow a:b=21:35$. Scale $b:c=7:8$ by $\times 5 \rightarrow b:c=35:40$. Now $a:b:c = 21:35:40$, so $a:c = 21:40$.

Q: Method — continued proportion (three terms in one ratio): If $a/10 = b/15 = c/20$, find $a:b:c$.

A: All three fractions equal the same constant, so $a:b:c$ is simply $10:15:20$, which reduces to $2:3:4$ (dividing by the HCF, 5).

Q: Method — chaining two ratios via a shared term: If $A:B=3:4$ and $B:C=8:9$, find $A:C$.

A: B is 4 in the first ratio and 8 in the second — scale the first ratio so B matches: multiply $A:B=3:4$ by 2 to get $A:B=6:8$. Now both ratios share $B=8$: $A:B:C = 6:8:9$. So $A:C = 6:9 = 2:3$.

Q: Method — mixture/alloy adjustment (add a pure ingredient to shift a ratio): A mixture of 60 L has acid:water = $2:1$. How much water must be added to make the ratio $1:2$?

A: Acid:water = $2:1$ in 60L means acid=40L, water=20L. We're only adding water (acid stays at 40L). We want acid:water = $1:2$, i.e. water = $2 \times \text{acid} = 80\text{L}$. Water to add = $80-20 = 60\text{L}$.

Q: Method — simplest form of an age ratio: Azhagan is 50 years old, his son is 10. What is the simplest ratio of their ages?

A: $50:10$ reduces (divide both by 10) to $5:1$.

Q: Method — finding an unknown in a proportion (cross-multiplication): If the numbers 2, 5, x , 20 (in that order) are in proportion, find x .

A: In proportion, $2:5 = x:20$, so $2 \times 20 = 5 \times x \rightarrow 40 = 5x \rightarrow x = 8$. (General rule: in $a:b=c:d$, $a \times d = b \times c$.)

Q: Method — the '4th proportional': Find the 4th proportional to 4, 16, and 7.

A: The 4th proportional x satisfies $4:16 = 7:x \rightarrow 4x = 16 \times 7 = 112 \rightarrow x = 28$.

Q: Method — splitting a total using a 3-part ratio and a given average: Three numbers are in ratio $3:5:7$ and their average is 60. Find the smallest number.

A: Average of 60 over 3 numbers means their total = 180. Split 180 in ratio $3:5:7$ (15 parts total): each part = $180/15 = 12$. Smallest = $3 \times 12 = 36$.

Q: Method — 'duplicate ratio' (squaring a ratio): What is the duplicate ratio of $2:7$?

A: The duplicate ratio of $a:b$ is $a^2:b^2$. So the duplicate ratio of $2:7$ is $4:49$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. A woman spends Rs.620 buying 14 pens and notebooks. One pen costs Rs.30, one notebook costs Rs.50. Find the ratio of notebooks to pens purchased.

- A. 2:5
- B. 5:2 ✓**
- C. 3:4
- D. 4:3

Explanation: $p+n=14$; $30p+50n=620 \rightarrow 3p+5n=62$. Substitute $p=14-n$: $3(14-n)+5n=62 \rightarrow 42+2n=62 \rightarrow n=10$, $p=4$. Ratio notebooks:pens = $10:4 = 5:2$. [hard, authored]

2. If $x/8 = y/12 = z/20$, find $x:y:z$ in lowest terms.

- A. 2:3:5 ✓**
- B. 8:12:20
- C. 4:6:10
- D. 1:2:3

Explanation: $x:y:z = 8:12:20$, which reduces (divide by HCF=4) to $2:3:5$. [easy, authored]

3. If $P:Q = 2:3$ and $Q:R = 9:10$, find $P:R$.

A. 3:5 ✓

B. 2:5

C. 3:10

D. 9:20

Explanation: Scale $P:Q=2:3$ by 3 to get $P:Q=6:9$, matching $Q=9$ from $Q:R=9:10$. So $P:Q:R=6:9:10$, giving $P:R=6:10=3:5$. [medium, authored]

4. A 40 L mixture has milk:water = 3:1. How much water must be added to change the ratio to 3:2?

A. 5 L

B. 10 L ✓

C. 8 L

D. 6 L

Explanation: Milk:water=3:1 in 40L means milk=30L, water=10L. Milk stays fixed; we want water= $(2/3) \times \text{milk} = (2/3) \times 30 = 20$ L. Water to add = $20 - 10 = 10$ L. [hard, authored]

5. If 5, 8, x, 24 are in proportion, find x.

A. 12.5

B. 15 ✓

C. 16

D. 20

Explanation: $5:8 = x:24 \rightarrow 5 \times 24 = 8x \rightarrow 120 = 8x \rightarrow x = 15$. [easy, authored]

6. Find the 4th proportional to 3, 12, and 9.

A. 27

B. 36 ✓

C. 30

D. 33

Explanation: $3:12 = 9:x \rightarrow 3x = 12 \times 9 = 108 \rightarrow x = 36$. [easy, authored]

7. Three numbers are in the ratio 2:3:4 and their average is 45. Find the largest number.

A. 40

B. 50

C. 60 ✓

D. 45

Explanation: Average 45 over 3 numbers means total=135. 9 parts total, each part=15. Largest = $4 \times 15 = 60$. [medium, authored]

8. What is the duplicate ratio of 3:5?

A. 6:10

B. 9:25 ✓

C. 9:10

D. 3:25

Explanation: Duplicate ratio = square each term: $3^2:5^2 = 9:25$. [easy, authored]

9. A sum of Rs.450 is divided among 100 boys and girls, each boy getting Rs.5.10 and each girl Rs.3.60. Find the number of girls.

A. 20

B. 30

C. 40 ✓

D. 50

Explanation: Let girls=g, boys=100-g. $3.6g + 5.1(100-g) = 450 \rightarrow 3.6g + 510 - 5.1g = 450 \rightarrow -1.5g = -60 \rightarrow g = 40$. [hard, authored]

10. A father's age (40) to his daughter's age (8) — what is the simplest ratio?

A. 5:1 ✓

B. 8:1

C. 4:1

D. 10:1

Explanation: 40:8 reduces ($\div 8$) to 5:1. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Technical Terms: Administrative and Departmental Terms

READING MATERIAL

Covers the precise meanings of common administrative and government-department terms — vocabulary a working government official would routinely encounter.

Q: What does 'Agenda' mean, and what is a 'Quorum'?

A: AGENDA = a schedule of items to be discussed (at a meeting). QUORUM = the minimum number of members required to be present to conduct a valid meeting.

Q: What does 'Incumbent' mean, and what is 'Tenure'?

A: INCUMBENT = the present holder of a position/office (not a former or temporary holder). TENURE = the period of time a person holds an office or position.

Q: What is a 'Gazette', and what is a 'Memorandum'?

A: GAZETTE = an official government journal/publication (used for publishing notifications, appointments, new rules, etc. — not a regular newspaper). MEMORANDUM (memo) = a short, informal official note (not a long formal report).

Q: What does 'Revenue' mean in a government/administrative context, and what does an 'Appointment Order' confirm?

A: REVENUE = income generated (not expenses). An APPOINTMENT ORDER is the official document confirming a person's job/position.

Q: What is the function of a 'Superintendent', and what does 'File Movement' refer to?

A: A SUPERINTENDENT supervises staff and administrative processes. FILE MOVEMENT refers to the tracking of official documents (files) as they move between offices/officials for processing.

Q: What does 'Deputation' mean, and what determines 'Seniority' for promotions?

A: DEPUTATION = a temporary posting/transfer of an employee to another department (not a permanent transfer, demotion, or resignation). SENIORITY (for promotion purposes) is determined by WORK EXPERIENCE AND RANK — not job title alone or training hours.

Q: Real exam: What does the acronym 'DGTD' stand for?

A: Directorate General of Technical Development.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The term 'Agenda' refers to:

- A. A duty list
- B. A summary
- C. A schedule of items to discuss ✓**
- D. A law passed

Explanation: A schedule of items to discuss. [easy, web-research]

2. 'Quorum' refers to:

- A. A voting method
- B. A voting list
- C. An office rule
- D. The minimum number required to conduct a meeting ✓**

Explanation: Minimum number required for a meeting. [medium, web-research]

3. The word 'Incumbent' means:

- A. A former officer
- B. The present holder of a position ✓**
- C. Temporary staff
- D. An in-charge officer only

Explanation: The present holder of a position. [medium, web-research]

4. A 'Gazette' is:

- A. A diary

B. A form of ID

C. A newspaper

D. An official government journal ✓

Explanation: An official government journal. [medium, web-research]

5. 'Revenue', in an administrative context, means:

A. Expenses incurred

B. Income generated ✓

C. A budget proposal

D. Refund details

Explanation: Income generated. [medium, web-research]

6. 'Deputation' refers to:

A. Permanent transfer to a higher post

B. Demotion

C. Job resignation

D. Temporary posting in another department ✓

Explanation: Temporary posting in another department. [medium, web-research]

7. 'File Movement' refers to:

A. Changing office furniture

B. Preparing reports

C. Arranging meetings

D. Tracking official documents ✓

Explanation: Tracking official documents. [medium, web-research]

8. Seniority for promotions is generally determined by:

A. Job title alone

B. Training hours

C. Department type

D. Work experience and rank ✓

Explanation: Work experience and rank. [medium, web-research]

9. The acronym 'DGTD' stands for:

A. Directorate General of Trade and Development

B. Department of Government Technical Departments

C. Directorate General of Technical Development ✓

D. District General Technical Division

Explanation: Directorate General of Technical Development. [hard, question-bank-2025]